voluntary and from private sources. On a closer look, this would mean that anyone making donations to this fund, made them in good spirit. In an effort to attract funds which corporations set aside for mandated corporate social responsibility (CSR), the fund was included in the eligibility list in the Companies Act to make CSR donations.[25] Conventionally, CSR contributions to private funds have not been allowed under the Companies Act, since many could use this as a loophole to divert monies in order to make them tax-free and indulge in tax evasion. However, based on this ambiguity, the Opposition used its might to attack the prime minister on charges of possible misspending, in other words, corruption.[26] Interestingly, Congress President Sonia Gandhi wrote in a letter dated 7 April, suggesting five ways in which the government could cut down expenditure and allocate more money towards pandemic management. One of those suggestions included transferring donations from the PM CARES fund to the Prime Minister's National Relief Fund (PMNRF) to ensure 'efficiency, transparency and accountability'.[27] To grasp the absurdity of this suggestion it is important to understand that contrary to popular media stories, the PMNRF is also outside the ambit of the RTI, as it is not a 'public authority' within the meaning of Section 2(h) of the RTI Act, 2005.[28] Even more interestingly, up until 2018, PMNRF's managing committee from the time of its constitution by former prime minister Jawaharlal Nehru included the Congress president, their chosen representatives from the private sector selected by FICCI and a representative from Tata Trustees along with the prime minister and finance minister. Even more strangely, the PMNRF, which was deemed to be a trust, has since functioned without a trust deed making its operations totally ambiguous.[29] More importantly, PMNRF is also audited by a private independent auditor. Interestingly, until very recently, the firm which was auditing PMNRF was owned by a Congress leader who rose to the ranks of a Union minister during the United Progressive Alliance (UPA) regime. In a Great Indian Mystery, funds from PMNRF were used to donate to the Rajiv Gandhi Foundation, thrice (2005, 2007 and 2008), as disclosed in the annual report.[30] What kind of relief measures was the Rajiv Gandhi Foundation engaging in to be considered an eligible beneficiary of the PMNRF, as per the wisdom of UPA leaders?

Changing up this archaic structure to one where realpolitik would take precedence by ensuring that the prime minister's discretion on disbursement